him free from the pyre of hell.'[22] Thus, Lashkar's jihad was not limited to liberating Kashmir, which helps to explain why the group began establishing networks to execute or support terrorist attacks against India as early as 1992. Once Kashmir was liberated, it could serve as a base of operations to reconquer India and restore Muslim rule to the Indian subcontinent. In other words, while the group's leaders spoke of waging jihad until the domination of Islam was achieved, for them the road to re-establishing the Caliphate ran through South Asia. Thus, while expanding its jihad after 9/11 to include America and its Western allies fit with Lashkar's pan-Islamist ideology, India would remain the primary enemy.

Lashkar's missionary ambitions are inherently sectarian. Its leaders state that the infidels invented sectarianism to divide Muslims and thwart them from waging jihad, and they have castigated other groups that engage in sectarian violence.[23] Yet Lashkar members were guilty of these offenses during the group's earliest years. As discussed in the previous chapter, the group was comfortable only with the Salafis in Kunar province and viewed most other Afghans as mushrikun. At the zenith of the Afghan jihad against the Soviets, some of its members were attacking non-Salafi Afghans instead. The practice of sectarian violence continued in Pakistan, where Lashkar members occasionally assaulted Shia and Barelvi Muslims, who they also denounced as mushrikun. These sectarian assaults in Pakistan stopped only when the group became more involved in the Kashmir jihad.[24] According to Noman Benotman, the leadership recognized the need to become more practical if it was going to increase its role in Indian-administered Kashmir, where most Muslims are Barelvi and Sufi. Lashkar's leaders asked him to spend time with its members and to serve as an example of a Salafi jihadi who had fought alongside non-Salafis in Afghanistan. He subsequently stayed at one of Lashkar's camps for several months in 1994, where he discussed with fighters the need to put sectarian differences aside and focus on fighting against the non-Muslim occupiers.[25] Efforts to take a more ecumenical approach were relatively, though not entirely, successful in Indian-administered Kashmir, where Lashkar militants still engaged in periodic sectarian assaults.[26]

Financial and organizational support from the state for Lashkar's participation in the Kashmir jihad enabled the group to build an infrastructure in Pakistan to pursue its missionary objectives via non-